Township of NIPISSING
"Life the way it should be"

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REPORT TO COUNCIL

Date: February 27, 2024

From: Kris Croskery-Hodgins, Municipal Administrator

Re: Proposed Town Hall Meeting

BACKGROUND/OVERVIEW

The Township of Nipissing Strategic Plan states the first goal of the plan is
Effective and Efficient Municipal Services.
To ensure the provision of effective and progressive communication with residents and visitors while maintaining municipal services and meeting the needs of the community.

Council feels strongly about interaction with the community in order to provide open and transparent governance. A request was made to staff by Council to research methods of community outreach and the scheduling of a Town Hall meeting.

NEXT STEPS

A Town Hall meeting with an open forum to have residents ask questions was requested during previous meetings in planning for the Strategic Plan.

Summer allows for participation by permanent and seasonal residents.

Planning now will allow for information to be included in the Spring and Summer newsletters as well as on the Township website and Social Media.

RECOMMENDATIONS:

A. In keeping with Council scheduling, a Town Hall meeting to be held Wednesday, July 17, 2024 from 6:30 p.m. to 8:00 p.m.

Location options:

1. Heritage Park, 14 Blake Street, Nipissing. This will require placing tents and a stage, securing a sound system for the event. Due to the outdoor venue, livestreaming of this meeting will not be suitable. Advertising the meeting in advance for personal attendance would be required.

2. Township of Nipissing Community Centre, 2381 Hwy 654. This location will allow for livestreaming, recording and accommodation for all.

3. Council may wish to consider scheduling two Town Hall meetings. One at the Commanda Community Centre and one at the Township of Nipissing Community Centre, similar to the Strategic Plan Public Meetings.

B. A Community Outreach Survey be created and circulated via electronic or paper method made available from the Township Office or the Township website. This will allow residents to share concerns, suggestions and insights into municipal operations and provide a basis of information to be shared at the Town Hall meeting in July. Survey to be approved by Council on March 19, 2024 and circulated until June 14, 2024. This will allow time to compile the information and present a report to Council at the July 16, 2024 regular meeting and share the results with residents at the Town Hall Meeting on July 17.

Respectfully,

Kris Croskery-Hodgins, Municipal Administrator